TOPIC 02 · SKILLS AND RULES
LAB 5 THEME · BUILT-IN SKILLS: VISUAL & FINANCE

Lab 5 — Analyse HR-Outsourcing Finances with Built-in Skills

Maps to	LO2: find, enable and call Copilot's built-in skills - chart-design, unit-economics, check-model and theme-design - and verify what each skill produces
Duration	40 minutes
Tools	Excel · Copilot (Allow editing, Plan, Chat only) · @chart-design · @unit-economics · @check-model · @theme-design
Mock data	data/BrightPath_HR_Outsourcing_Finance.xlsx
Course	Microsoft 365 Copilot for Excel (C34) · v3.0
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C34-Microsoft-365-Copilot-for-Excel/prompts/#lab-5

Goal

Use four built-in skills to chart BrightPath's recurring revenue, calculate client unit economics, audit a headcount budget model and style the results - then prove the numbers.

What You Will Do

BrightPath's HR-outsourcing business sells monthly payroll and HR services to client companies. Finance wants to know whether winning clients pays off and whether next year's headcount budget is right. You will switch on skills in Manage plugins & skills, call them with @, and let each one do a specialist job: @chart-design builds the revenue chart, @unit-economics works out CAC, LTV and payback, @check-model finds the errors in the budget model, and @theme-design styles the workbook. A Checks sheet proves every headline number.

What You Will Build

BrightPath_HR_Outsourcing_Finance.xlsx with a skill-designed MRR chart, a Unit_Economics sheet, a corrected Headcount_Budget, a Checks sheet that agrees with the skills, and a consistent theme

Prerequisites

- Lab 4 completed: you know how rules guide Copilot inside one workbook.
- This lab folder's data/BrightPath_HR_Outsourcing_Finance.xlsx. Skills need Excel's display language set to English.

Data note

Use only the supplied fictional BrightPath data or information you are authorised to process. Do not paste credentials, confidential business material or real employees' personal data into Copilot, rules or skills.

Steps

Step 1. Copy BrightPath_HR_Outsourcing_Finance.xlsx from this lab's data folder into a work-c34 folder on your computer and open it in Excel for Microsoft 365 (desktop). Work on this local copy - no OneDrive upload is needed. Check that Formulas > Calculation Options is Automatic, then open Copilot from the Copilot button on the Home tab or the floating Copilot icon at the bottom right. Read the About_This_Data sheet before you prompt. Read the Definitions row on About_This_Data - you will hold the finance skill to these.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Tables : tblClientMonths (18 months) | tblClients | tblSpend | Headcount_Budget (cost model)
H1 2026 = Jan-Jun 2026
CAC = sales & marketing spend / new clients
ARPA = MRR / active clients at Jun 2026
LTV = ARPA x gross margin / monthly churn
Payback = CAC / (ARPA x gross margin), in months
```

Step 2. Turn on the skills. In the Copilot pane select Settings (...) > Manage plugins & skills. Open the Finance folder and turn on unit-economics and check-model. Open the Visualisation folder and turn on chart-design (it is off by default). Leave every other skill as it is. Close the dialog, type @ in the prompt box and confirm all three are listed. theme-design (Step 7) sits in a Formatting folder that is still rolling out - if you have no Formatting folder, skip it; Step 7 shows what to do.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Where : Settings (...) > Manage plugins & skills - turn on only these
Finance : unit-economics, check-model
Visualisation : chart-design (off by default)
Formatting : theme-design - only if this folder is shown
Call a skill : type @ and its name, e.g. @chart-design

CHAT ONLY:
Which of your skills would help me analyse client acquisition cost and churn in this workbook,
and which would help me audit the Headcount_Budget sheet? Do not change anything.
```

Step 3. Call @chart-design (Visualisation) in Allow editing. It chooses and formats the chart using the Excel design team's guidance. Check the values: MRR grows from S$238,200 in Jan 2025 to S$482,200 in Jun 2026, with 131 active clients at the end.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ALLOW EDITING:
@chart-design Create a combo chart on a new sheet Charts from tblClientMonths: MRR as columns
and Clients_End as a line on a secondary axis, Jan 2025 to Jun 2026.

FOLLOW-UP:
@chart-design Improve this chart for a leadership slide: a title that states the finding, axis
titles with units, and a data label on the last month only.
```

Step 4. Call the finance skill @unit-economics in Plan mode, so you can review its approach before it builds. Check that the plan uses H1 2026 and the About_This_Data definitions; reply with corrections if not, then approve and select Done.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
PLAN MODE:
@unit-economics Analyse the unit economics of BrightPath's HR-outsourcing clients for H1 2026
using tblClientMonths, tblClients and tblSpend. Use the definitions on About_This_Data. Put
the results on a new sheet Unit_Economics: CAC, ARPA, gross margin, monthly churn, LTV,
LTV:CAC and payback months, plus CAC by Channel. List your assumptions.
```

Step 5. Never trust a skill's numbers without a check. Ask Copilot to add these independent formulas, then compare them with the Unit_Economics sheet. If they differ, ask the skill to show its calculation and use the definition.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
CHECK (Allow editing):
```

```
Create a sheet named Checks. Enter these labels and formulas exactly as written, then tell me
each result:
A1 New clients H1 B1
=SUMIFS(tblClientMonths[New_Clients],tblClientMonths[Month],">="&DATE(2026,1,1))
A2 S&M spend H1 B2
=SUMIFS(tblClientMonths[Sales_Marketing_Spend],tblClientMonths[Month],">="&DATE(2026,1,1))
A3 CAC B3 =B2/B1
A4 ARPA B4 =INDEX(tblClientMonths[MRR],18)/INDEX(tblClientMonths[Clients_End],18)
A5 Gross margin B5
=AVERAGEIFS(tblClientMonths[Gross_Margin_Pct],tblClientMonths[Month],">="&DATE(2026,1,1))
A6 Monthly churn B6 =AVERAGE(FILTER(tblClientMonths[Churned_Clients]/tblClientMonths[Clients_
Start],tblClientMonths[Month]>=DATE(2026,1,1)))
A7 LTV B7 =B4*B5/B6
A8 LTV to CAC B8 =B7/B3
A9 Payback months B9 =B3/(B4*B5)

FOLLOW-UP:
Compare Checks!B3:B9 with the Unit_Economics sheet. Show any value that differs and why.
```

Step 6. Audit a model with @check-model. Ask for the findings first in Chat only, read them, then switch to Allow editing and ask for the fixes. It should find three problems: a typed number in E3, an 11-month formula in E6 and a total in E10 that misses the last role.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
CHAT ONLY:
@check-model Audit the Headcount_Budget sheet: look for typed numbers in formula columns,
formulas that differ from their neighbours, and totals that miss rows. List each issue with
its cell, what is wrong and the fix. Do not change anything yet.

ALLOW EDITING:
Fix the issues you found on Headcount_Budget and tell me the new Total FY2027 cost.
```

Step 7. Style the workbook with @theme-design (Formatting). It applies one coordinated theme to cells, tables and charts. If theme-design is not in your @ list, your account does not have it yet: delete @theme-design and run the rest of the prompt as it is. If your organisation has set up a brand kit, try @brandkit instead. Then log your prompts.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ALLOW EDITING:
@theme-design Apply one clean, professional theme to the Charts, Unit_Economics, Checks and
Headcount_Budget sheets.

LOG (Allow editing):
Prompt_Log already lists every prompt in this lab. For each one I ran, fill in What Copilot
did and How I verified, and set Decision to Keep. I will tell you any row to change to Revise
or Undo.
```

Sample Prompts

Use these prompts in the Copilot pane (or adapt them). Name the table and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. The same prompts are in sample-prompts.txt in this lab folder.

Copy-ready prompts online:
https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C34-Microsoft-365-Copilot-for-Excel/prompts/#lab-5

#	Purpose	Prompt
1	Find skills	Which skills do you have for charts, formatting and finance? When would I use each one?
2	Chart skill	@chart-design Recommend the best chart for new vs churned clients by month, then create it.
3	Finance skill	@unit-economics Compare CAC and payback months by acquisition Channel for H1 2026.
4	Audit skill	@check-model Check this sheet for hardcoded numbers, broken formulas and totals that miss rows.

#	Purpose	Prompt
5	Style skill	@theme-design Apply a coordinated theme to this workbook.
6	Brand skill	@brandkit Apply our organisation's brand colours and fonts to the charts.
7	Explain	Explain how you calculated LTV, step by step, with the cells you used.
8	Question	Which acquisition channel has the lowest CAC in H1 2026, and how many clients did it bring?

Test It

Check	Expected result
New clients and spend, H1 2026	38 clients; S$560,420
CAC and ARPA	S$14,748; S$3,681
Margin and monthly churn	44.9%; 2.06%
LTV, LTV:CAC, payback	About S$80,433; 5.5; 8.9 months
CAC by channel	Lowest Referral S$5,180; highest Events S$33,445
@check-model fixes	E3, E6, E10: total S$1,437,934 -> S$1,703,052

Checkpoint

Keep the workbook in work-c34. Lab 6 needs your OneDrive for one thing only: custom skills are stored there.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Manage plugins & skills is missing or greyed out.	Wait 10 seconds - it loads after the pane. Then check Excel is up to date and the Office display language is English.
A skill is not listed when I type @.	Turn it on in Manage plugins & skills, or type its full name: an @mention works even when the skill is off.
The skill's CAC or LTV differs from Checks.	Skills use their own defaults. Ask: 'Use the definitions on About_This_Data and recalculate CAC and LTV.'
@check-model changes the sheet straight away.	You were in Allow editing. Select Undo, switch to Chat only and ask for the findings first.

Challenge

Ask @unit-economics for a client cohort table by Sign_Date quarter showing how many clients from each cohort are still active. Check one cohort with COUNTIFS on tblClients.

Reflection

Which skill saved you the most time, and which of its numbers would you not have trusted without the Checks sheet?